DICEFORGE STUDIOS

VEHICLE FORGE

COMPANION GUIDE

Universal Vehicle Construction for Savage Worlds

Everything from war chariots to star dreadnoughts. One tool. Any era. Any environment.

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Credits & Legal

Writing & Design: DiceForge Studios Ltd.

Vehicle Forge Tool: DiceForge Studios Ltd.

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You will need the Savage Worlds core rules to use this product. The Science Fiction Companion is recommended for campaigns involving walkers, starships, or advanced technology vehicles.

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Contents

Introduction

"The difference between a good GM and a great one is preparation. The difference between a great GM and a legendary one is knowing when to stop preparing and start playing."

Welcome to the Vehicle Forge Companion Guide — your complete reference for building vehicles, war machines, and fighting craft for the Savage Worlds roleplaying game. Whether you need a WWII medium tank for tonight's session, a pirate frigate for a swashbuckling campaign, or a capital ship for a far-future war, the Forge builds it in minutes.

The Vehicle Forge is a standalone HTML tool that runs in any modern browser. It ships with 122 weapons across seven technological eras, 41 modifications across eight categories, and 47 reference builds covering everything from bicycles to battleships. All content is original DiceForge material — the tool references Savage Worlds mechanics by name but does not reproduce them.

This guide covers everything you need to get the most from the Forge. The opening chapters walk you through the interface and construction sequence. The reference chapters document every modification, weapon, and special ability. The walkthroughs build three complete vehicles step by step, explaining every choice. The closing chapters discuss design philosophy and the supplement ecosystem.

Design Philosophy

Fast, Furious, Fun

Savage Worlds lives by those three words, and so does the Vehicle Forge. Every design decision prioritised speed of play over simulation depth. Six sliders. Real-time stat block. One-click export. You can build a vehicle in two minutes and have it in play in three.

Build What You Need

You will never use all 122 weapons in a single campaign. Nor should you. Build vehicles that serve your story. A WWII one-sheet needs three or four vehicles at most. A pirate campaign might use a dozen ships over its entire run. The reference builds exist to give you a starting point — load one, adjust it, and move on.

Show, Don't Stat

A stat block is a skeleton. The vehicle comes alive through description, through the way the GM narrates its guns firing and its armour ringing, through the players' choices under fire. The Forge gives you the numbers. You give them meaning.

Getting Started

Opening the Forge

The Vehicle Forge runs in any modern web browser — Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge. Open the URL and start building. No installation, no account, no subscription. The interface is divided into panels: the left sidebar handles vehicle identity, Size selection, and locomotion. The main panel contains tabs for modifications, weapons, special abilities, and the live stat block output.

The Construction Sequence

Vehicle construction follows a natural sequence, though you can jump between tabs at any time.

1. Name and Concept. Start with what the vehicle is. A scout car. A patrol frigate. A heavy bomber. Type a name and write a one-line description that captures its purpose.

2. Size. Slide the Size picker to set your vehicle's scale. Size determines the frame category (Normal, Large, Huge, Gargantuan), which sets base Toughness, Wounds, crew capacity, and mod slots.

3. Locomotion. Choose how the vehicle moves. The Forge offers eleven locomotion types spanning ground, water, air, and walker categories. Locomotion sets base speed and determines which terrain rules apply.

4. Sliders. Adjust Toughness, Armour, Speed, Handling, Wounds, and Crew. Each slider modifies the frame defaults. The stat block updates in real time as you drag.

5. Modifications. Install mods from the catalogue. Each mod consumes mod slots. Drawbacks give slots back at a cost. The mod counter tracks your budget.

6. Weapons. Mount weapons from the era-filtered catalogue. Choose Pintle (standard cost), Fixed (half cost, forward arc only), or Turret (double cost, 360° arc). Each weapon has a minimum Size requirement.

7. Special Abilities. Toggle Special Abilities to add narrative and mechanical flavour. These cost no mod slots — they describe what the vehicle is, not what it has.

8. Export. Copy the stat block to clipboard in Pinnacle format, export as Fantasy Grounds XML, or save as JSON for backup and sharing.

> **TIP:** *Export your vehicles regularly. Browser storage is convenient but not permanent — clearing your cache will delete your builds.*

Vehicle Frames

Every vehicle starts with a frame determined by its Size. The frame sets baseline statistics that modifications, weapons, and special abilities build upon.

Size	Frame	Toughness	Wounds	Crew	Mods	Handling
-2 to 0	Normal	3–7	3	1	3–5	+1
1 to 3	Normal	6–8	3	1	3–7	+1
4 to 7	Large	9–12	4	1+	10–17	0
8 to 11	Huge	13–16	5	5+	20–27	-1
12 to 16	Gargantuan	17–21	6	20+	30–40	-2
17 to 23	Gargantuan	22–28	7	100+	42–57	-3
24+	Gargantuan	29+	8	500+	60+	-4

Vehicle Class

The Forge assigns a Vehicle Class from A (lightest) to G (heaviest) based on Size, for quick comparison across eras and genres.

Class	Size	Frame	Examples
A	-2 to 0	Normal	Bicycles, motorcycles, jet skis
B	1 to 3	Normal	Cars, carriages, small boats
C	4 to 7	Large	SUVs, APCs, tanks, fighters
D	8 to 11	Huge	Semi-trucks, heavy tanks, bombers
E	12 to 16	Gargantuan	Galleons, corvettes, locomotives
F	17 to 23	Gargantuan	Cruisers, destroyers, transports
G	24+	Gargantuan	Battleships, carriers, capital ships

Locomotion

Locomotion type defines how the vehicle moves, its base speed range, and how it interacts with terrain and environment. The Forge offers eleven types across four categories.

Ground Vehicles

Type	Speed Range	Notes
Wheeled	~15–215 MPH	Cars, trucks, motorcycles. Most common ground type.
Tracked	~15–85 MPH	Tanks, APCs. Ignores Difficult Ground.
Hover	~30–205 MPH	Hovercraft, grav vehicles. Ignores most terrain.

Water Vehicles

Type	Speed Range	Notes
Sail	~8–56 MPH	Wind-powered. Unlimited range, weather-dependent.
Turbine (Water)	~17–125 MPH	Motor boats, warships.
Jet (Water)	~30–155 MPH	Hydrofoils, fast attack craft.

Aircraft

Type	Speed Range	Notes
VTOL	~90–770 MPH	Helicopters, tiltrotors. Vertical takeoff.
Turboprop	~160–770 MPH	Propeller aircraft, transports.
Jet	~430–2,250 MPH	Fighters, bombers, airliners.

Walkers

Type	Speed Range	Notes
Biped	~12–60 MPH	Walkers, mechs. Piloting skill. Fighting + Stomp.
Multileg	~12–48 MPH	Quadrupeds, war beasts. Reroll failed Piloting vs Out of Control.

TIP: *Don't overthink locomotion. If it has wheels, it's Wheeled. If it has tracks, it's Tracked. If it walks on two legs, it's Biped. The Forge handles the rest.*

Modifications Reference

The Forge provides 41 modifications across eight categories. Each modification has a maximum number of takes, a mod slot cost, and a description of its effect. Drawbacks have negative costs — they give slots back at a price.

Drawbacks

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Unmanned	1	-2	
Open Crew	3	-1	
Temperamental	2	-2	
Gas-Guzzler	1	-1	
Low-Tech	1	-2	
Skeleton Crew	1	-1	
Bone Shaker	1	-1	
Death Trap	1	-1	

Core Systems

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Machine Intelligence	3	2	
Enhanced Sensors	1	1	
Tactical Relay	1	2	
Signal Rig	2	1	
Remote Operator	1	1	
Detection Grid	1	1	
Sensor Array	1	4	

Defensive Systems

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Sloped Armour	1	3	
Countermeasure Suite	1	1	
Surge Protection	1	2	
Crew Escape	1	2	
Nanorepair System	2	3	
Deflection Field	1	3	
Stealth System	1	sizehalf	

Offensive Systems

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Gimballed Weapons	1	1	
Fire Control	1	2	

Locomotion & Power

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Amphibious Kit	2	2	
Boost Injector	4	1	
Reserve Tanks	U	2	
Off-Road Package	1	1	
Fusion Core	1	4	
Road Vehicle	1	0	
Submersible	2	2	
Variable Form	1	3	

Personnel

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Berths	U	2	
Comfort Upgrade	3	comfort	
Troop Bay	U	2	
Specialist Workshop	U	3	
Environmental Seal	1	2	

Structural

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Vehicle Bay	U	4	
Compact Engineering	3	-1	

Walker Systems

Modification	Max	Mods	Effect
Jump Jets	1	1	
Dual Cockpit	1	-1	

TIP: *Drawbacks make vehicles interesting. A Temperamental engine and a Bone Shaker suspension tell a story before the first shot is fired.*

Weapons Reference

The Forge provides 122 weapons across seven technological eras. Weapons are grouped by era and category. Each weapon lists its range, damage, AP, rate of fire, mod slot cost, and notes.

Ancient Era (8)

Pre-gunpowder weapons: siege engines, rams, fire siphons, ranged batteries. Bronze Age through late Roman.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Scorpion	15/30/60	2d6	2	1	1	Reload 1, HW
Onager	24/48/96	3d6	0	1	2	Reload 4, Indirect, MBT
Polybolos	15/30/60	2d6	2	2	1	Reload 1, Repeating ballista, HW
Greek Fire Siphon	Cone	2d8	0	1	1	Cone 12", Incendiary, Clean Burn
Bow Battery	12/24/48	2d6	1	2	1	Crew of archers, Reload 1
Javelin Rack	4/8/16	2d4	0	3	1	Thrown, limited range
Scythed Wheels	—	Str+2d6	2	0	1	Melee, damages adjacent on pass, HW
Bronze Ram	—	Str+2d8	4	0	1	Ship ram, melee only, HW

Medieval Era (8)

Improved siege engines, trebuchets, and defensive weapons. Dark Ages through late medieval.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Ballista	15/30/60	3d6	2	1	1	Reload 2, HW
Catapult	24/48/96	3d8	0	1	2	Reload 4, Indirect, MBT
Trebuchet	24/48/96	4d8	4	1	3	Reload 6, Indirect, LBT
Mangonel	18/36/72	3d6	0	1	2	Reload 3, Indirect, MBT
Springald	20/40/80	2d8	4	1	1	Reload 2, AP bolt, HW
Battering Ram	—	Str+2d8	4	0	1	Melee only, HW
Boiling Oil/Pitch	Cone	2d10	0	1	1	Cone, Incendiary
Fire Arrows	12/24/48	2d6	0	2	1	Incendiary, Reload 1

Blackpowder Era (8)

Gunpowder weapons from the Age of Sail through Napoleonic wars. Smoothbore cannon, carronades, mortars.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Swivel Gun	12/24/48	2d8	2	1	1	Reload 2, Grapeshot (Cone)
Light Cannon	20/40/80	3d6+1	4	1	1	Reload 3, SBT, HW
Medium Cannon	25/50/100	4d6+1	4	1	2	Reload 3, SBT, HW
Heavy Cannon	30/60/120	5d6	6	1	3	Reload 4, SBT, HW
Carronade	10/20/40	4d6+2	2	1	1	Reload 2, Grapeshot (Cone), HW
Mortar	24/48/96	3d8	0	1	1	Reload 3, Indirect, MBT, HW

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Congreve Rocket	18/36/72	3d6	0	1	1	Inaccurate (-1 Shooting), Incendiary, MBT
Chain Shot	15/30/60	3d6	0	1	0	Anti-rigging. Reload 3. Targets mast/locomotion only

Industrial Era (13)

Late 19th century through WWII. The transition from muscle to machine. Machine guns, tank guns, autocannons.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Medium Machine Gun	30/60/120	2d8+1	2	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Heavy Machine Gun	50/100/200	2d10	4	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire, HW
20mm Cannon	50/100/200	2d12	4	4	1	HW
37mm Tank Gun	50/100/200	4d8	3	1	2	SBT, HW
75mm Tank Gun	75/150/300	4d10	6	1	3	SBT, HW
76mm Tank Gun	75/150/300	4d10	10	1	3	SBT, HW
88mm Tank Gun	100/200/400	4d10+1	16	1	4	SBT, HW
Heavy Flamethrower	Cone	3d8	0	1	1	Cone or MBT 18", Incendiary
Torpedo	300/600/1200	8d10	22	1	1	LBT, Aquatic only, HW
Bomb Bay	—	4d8	4	1	2	Aircraft only. Drop, MBT. Bombing run rules.
Depth Charges	—	4d8	4	1	1	Drop, MBT. Anti-sub only.
Naval Gun	100/200/400	5d10	12	1	4	SBT, HW. Deck-mounted.
Naval Mine Layer	—	5d10	8	0	2	Deploy mine per round. 3d6 trigger radius.

Modern Era (23)

Cold War through present day. Guided weapons, electronic warfare, precision strike.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Heavy Machine Gun	50/100/200	2d10	4	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire, HW
Medium Machine Gun	30/60/120	2d8+1	2	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Minigun	50/100/200	2d8+1	2	5	1	Min RoF 3, Pt Def, Rxn Fire, HW
25mm Cannon	50/100/200	3d8	4	3	1	Min RoF 2, HW
30mm Cannon	50/100/200	3d8	6	3	1	Min RoF 2, HW
40mm Cannon	75/150/300	4d8	5	4	2	Min RoF 2, HW
Light Autocannon	50/100/200	3d8	4	4	1	Min RoF 2, Pt Def, Rxn Fire, HW
120mm Tank Gun	100/200/400	5d10	31	1	4	SBT, HW
125mm Tank Gun	100/200/400	5d10	30	1	4	SBT, HW
TOW Launcher	75/150/300	5d10	34	1	1	Guided (wire), SBT, HW. Cannot be jammed.
Hellfire Missile	150/300/600	5d10	40	1	1	Guided (laser), MBT, HW

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Sidewinder Missile	100/200/400	4d8	6	1	1	Guided (heat), SBT, HW
Sparrow Missile	150/300/600	5d8	6	1	1	Guided (radar), SBT, HW
ATGM Launcher	75/150/300	5d10	34	1	1	Guided (wire), SBT, HW
SAM Launcher	100/200/400	5d6	10	1	1	Guided, SBT, HW
Rocket Pod	50/100/200	4d8	6	3	1	SBT, HW
Grenade Launcher	24/48/96	3d6	0	1	1	MBT
Modern Torpedo	100/200/400	6d10	16	1	2	Guided, LBT, Aquatic only
CIWS / Phalanx	30/60/120	2d10	4	6	2	Pt Def only. Auto-fire vs missiles/aircraft.
Naval Gun (5-inch)	150/300/600	5d10+2	14	1	4	SBT, HW. Deck-mounted.
Cruise Missile	500/1K/2K	8d6	24	1	2	Guided, LBT, HW. Extreme range.
Bomb Bay / Hardpoint	—	5d8	8	1	2	Aircraft only. Drop, MBT. Precision guided.
Depth Charges	—	5d8	6	1	1	Drop, MBT. Anti-sub only.

Future Era (40)

Science fiction. The largest catalogue at 39 weapons. Everything from infantry-scale machine guns to capital-ship lasers.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Heavy Slugthrower	50/100/200	2d10	4	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Medium Autocannon	50/100/200	4d8	6	4	2	Min RoF 2
Gatling Laser	50/100/200	3d6+4	4	4	1	Clean Burn, Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Light Laser	150/300/600	2d10	10	3	1	Clean Burn, Rxn Fire
Medium Laser	150/300/600	3d10	20	2	3	Clean Burn
Heavy Laser	150/300/600	4d10	30	1	5	Clean Burn
Heavy Cannon	100/200/400	5d10	20	1	5	SBT
Super Cannon	150/300/600	6d10	30	1	6	MBT
Heavy Flamethrower	Cone	3d12	0	1	1	Clean Burn, Incendiary, Cone 18"
Light Missiles (×8)	100/200/400	6d6	16	4	0	Guided, SBT
Medium Missiles (×4)	150/300/600	7d6	24	2	0	Guided, MBT
Heavy Missiles (×2)	200/400/800	8d6	32	1	0	Guided, LBT
Missile Launcher	—	—	0	0	1	Rack only. Load missiles separately.
Plasma Torpedo	100/200/400	6d10	20	1	2	Guided, LBT, Aquatic/Space
Light Autocannon	50/100/200	3d8	4	4	1	Min RoF 2, Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Heavy Autocannon	75/150/300	5d8	8	4	3	Min RoF 2
Micro Bombs	25/50/100	3d6	4	1	0	Bomblet swarm, LBT
Light Bomb	—	6d10	5	4	0	Drop only, LBT. Requires Bomb Rack.
Medium Bomb	—	8d10	10	2	0	Drop only, 10" radius. Requires Bomb Rack.
Heavy Bomb	—	10d10	10	1	0	Drop only, 25" radius. Requires Bomb Rack.
Bomb Rack	—	—	0	0	1	Rack only. Holds one

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
						bomb type. Load bombs separately.
Light Cannon	50/100/200	3d10	5	1	1	SBT, Rxn Fire. HE: 3d8 LBT AP 0
Medium Cannon	75/150/300	4d10	10	1	3	SBT. HE: 4d8 LBT AP 5
Super Heavy Cannon	150/300/600	8d10	40	1	8	MBT. HE: 8d8 LBT AP 20
Light Ion Cannon	75/150/300	5d8	0	1	3	EMP. No actual Wounds — knocks out electronics if damage >= Toughness.
Medium Ion Cannon	75/150/300	7d8	0	1	4	EMP. No actual Wounds — knocks out electronics if damage >= Toughness.
Heavy Ion Cannon	75/150/300	9d8	0	1	5	EMP. No actual Wounds — knocks out electronics if damage >= Toughness.
Micro Missiles	25/50/100	3d6	0	1	0	Swarm pod, LBT, Guided, ignores Pt Def
Micro Rockets	20/40/80	3d6	0	1	0	Swarm pod, LBT, ignores Pt Def
Light Rockets (×8)	20/40/80	6d6	16	4	0	SBT, No Recoil
Medium Rockets (×4)	20/40/80	7d6	24	2	0	MBT, No Recoil
Heavy Rockets (×2)	20/40/80	8d6	32	1	0	LBT, No Recoil
Rocket Launcher	—	—	0	0	1	Rack only. Load rockets separately.
Light Machine Gun	30/60/120	2d8	2	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire. NOT a Heavy Weapon.
Medium Machine Gun	30/60/120	2d8+1	2	3	1	Pt Def, Rxn Fire. NOT a Heavy Weapon.
Minigun	50/100/200	2d8+1	2	5	1	Min RoF 3, Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Mine	—	4d6	10	1	0	LBT. Deploy or launch at half Grenade Launcher range. Can be fitted with warheads.
Grenade Launcher	24/48/96	3d6	0	3	1	MBT. Can load warhead grenades.
Stun Ray	50/100/200	—	0	1	1	Vigor –4 or Stunned (–6 on raise). No effect on vehicles or robots.
Stun Projector	25/50/100	—	0	1	1	Cone. Vigor –4 or Stunned (–6 on raise). No effect on vehicles or robots.

Advanced Era (22)

Far-future and exotic technology. Railguns, particle beams, mass drivers. Twenty-two weapons across seven categories.

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Light Mass Driver	100/200/400	2d12+2	5	3	2	Pt Def, Rxn Fire, SBT
Medium Mass Driver	100/200/400	3d12+3	5	2	3	MBT
Light Particle Cannon	100/200/400	4d6+4	5	3	2	Pt Def, Rxn Fire
Medium Particle Cannon	100/200/400	6d6+6	10	3	4	

Weapon	Range	Damage	AP	RoF	Mods	Notes
Super Laser	150/300/600	5d10	30	1	8	Clean Burn
Plasma Cannon	75/150/300	5d10	20	1	4	Clean Burn, Incendiary, SBT
Railgun	200/400/800	5d12	40	1	6	SBT, Ignores Shields
Super Heavy Laser	150/300/600	6d10	40	1	12	Clean Burn
Mega Laser	150/300/600	8d10	40	1	16	Clean Burn. 1 minute recharge after firing. Cannot be Linked or d.
Heavy Mass Driver	100/200/400	4d12+4	5	1	4	LBT
Super Mass Driver	100/200/400	6d12+6	5	1	8	10" (20 yard) radius
Super Heavy Mass Driver	100/200/400	8d12+8	5	1	12	25" (50 yard) radius
Mega Mass Driver	100/200/400	10d12+10	5	1	16	50" (100 yard) radius. Planetary bombardment.
Light Particle Beam	75/150/300	5d8	24	2	3	Beam, Rxn Fire
Medium Particle Beam	75/150/300	7d8	32	2	4	Beam
Heavy Particle Beam	75/150/300	9d8	40	2	5	Beam
Heavy Particle Cannon	100/200/400	8d6+8	20	3	6	
Light Torpedo	300/600/1200	6d10	20	2	0	Guided, LBT. Space or liquid only.
Medium Torpedo	300/600/1200	7d10	30	1	0	Guided, LBT. Space or liquid only.
Heavy Torpedo	300/600/1200	8d12	40	1	0	Guided, LBT. Space or liquid only.
Torpedo Launcher	—	—	0	0	2	Rack only. Load torpedoes separately.
Gravity Cannon	50/100/200	5d12	10	1	5	LBT. Targets Shaken or Wounded are also Distracted.

Weapon Mounting

Every weapon must be mounted. The mount type determines the weapon's firing arc and its mod slot cost.

Pintle Mount

The standard mount. A pintle-mounted weapon has a limited firing arc (typically 180°) and costs the weapon's listed mod slots. Most vehicle weapons use pintle mounts.

Fixed Mount

A weapon bolted to the hull, firing only in the vehicle's forward arc. Fixed weapons cost half the weapon's listed mod slots (rounded up). The restriction in arc is compensated by the savings in space.

Turret Mount

A weapon in a rotating mount with 360° firing arc. Turret weapons cost double the weapon's listed mod slots. The flexibility is worth the premium — a turret-mounted main gun can engage threats from any direction.

> **TIP:** *Mount your primary weapon in a turret and secondary weapons fixed or pintle. This concentrates your mod budget on the weapon that matters most.*

Walkthrough: M4 Sherman

"The Sherman wasn't the best tank in the war. It was the best tank for winning the war. Reliable, mass-produced, and everywhere it needed to be."

Concept

An American WWII medium tank — the backbone of Allied armoured forces from North Africa to Berlin. Not the heaviest or the fastest, but reliable, well-armed for its class, and available in numbers that no other nation could match. We're building the definitive mid-war Sherman, the kind rolling off the Detroit production lines in 1943.

Starting Point: How Big Is a Medium Tank?

A Sherman weighs 33 tonnes and stretches about 20 feet from bow plate to engine deck. The Class System table says that's solidly Large frame (Size 4–7). We start with Size 6 — set the Size slider and click Tracked in the Locomotion panel. The stat block updates: base Toughness 11, Handling +0, Wounds 4, and 15 mod slots. The mod counter sits in the top right — we'll be watching that number.

We check the weapon panel, filtered to Industrial era. The 75mm Tank Gun shows minimum Size 5 — fine at Size 6 — and costs 3 mod slots. Two Medium Machine Guns at 1 slot each. Five slots on weapons. The mod counter drops from 15 to 10.

The Problem: Armour Isn't Thick Enough

We slide Armour up two notches and watch the stat block recalculate. Toughness reads 22(8). We know from the core rules what those numbers mean at the table, and we know from the weapon panel that a 75mm anti-tank gun does 4d10 with AP 6. That's a coin-flip — and the colonel building this tank doesn't bet his crew's lives on coin-flips.

We bump the Size slider to 7. Still Large frame — no category change — but the stat block shifts. Base Toughness climbs from 11 to 12. With the same Toughness +1 and Armour +2 settings, the display now reads Toughness 23(8). One point higher. The mod counter jumps to 12 remaining — Size 7 gives 17 total slots instead of 15. Better odds, more room to grow.

Finalising the Design

We type 30 into the MPH Override field. The speed slider greys out and Top Speed locks to 30 MPH — the Sherman's road speed, confirmed by every reference source. Handling drops one notch to -1, because WW2 tanks were not agile. Crew set to 5: commander, gunner, loader, driver, bow gunner.

The 75mm Tank Gun goes into the turret mount — 360° traverse, 3 slots. One Medium Machine Gun co-axial (Fixed, 1 slot), one in the hull (Fixed Front, 1 slot). Heavy Armour ticked in the modifications list. We click Export:

```
M4 SHERMAN
WWII medium tank, reliable and mass-produced.
Size 7 (Large) • Handling -1 • Top Speed 30 MPH
Toughness 23(8) • Crew 5 • Wounds 4
Weapons: 75mm Tank Gun (Turret), 2× Medium MG (Fixed)
Notes: Heavy Armour, Tracked
```

Load the WW2 Medium Tank (Allied) reference build and compare. The numbers land in the same neighbourhood, because the tool produces realistic results when you feed it realistic inputs.

TIP: *The Sherman had dozens of variants — the M4A3E8 "Easy Eight" with a 76mm gun, the M4A3R3 flamethrower, the M4A1(76)W with wet stowage. Build the base, then adjust. That's how the real factories did it.*

Walkthrough: 32-Gun Frigate

"A frigate was the eyes of the fleet and the terror of the merchant lanes. Fast enough to catch anything she could fight, and fast enough to run from anything she couldn't."

Concept

An 18th-century naval frigate — the workhorse of any blue-water navy. Not a lumbering ship of the line, but a fast, manoeuvrable warship carrying her guns on a single covered deck. The kind of vessel that hunted privateers, escorted convoys, and carried dispatches across oceans.

Starting Point: How Big Is a Frigate?

A fifth-rate frigate displaces 700–900 tonnes and measures about 130 feet on the gun deck. That's Huge frame territory — bigger than most land vehicles, smaller than a ship of the line. We start at Size 9, set Locomotion to Sail, and see: base Toughness 14, Handling -1, Wounds 5, 22 mod slots. Wind-powered means no fuel costs and unlimited range.

But a frigate is defined by her guns. We check the Blackpowder era weapons. Medium Cannon costs 2 mod slots each in Pintle mounts. We need eight of them for the main battery — that's 16 slots. At Size 9 with 22 total, that leaves only 6 for everything else. Tight.

The Problem: Not Enough Slots

We bump to Size 10 — still Huge, but 25 mod slots. Nine more than the guns need. That's room for armour, rigging upgrades, and crew quarters. Size 10 also bumps base Toughness to 15, which better represents the thick oak hull of a proper warship.

Finalising the Design

Armour +2 for the reinforced hull planking. MPH Override to 12 — a well-handled frigate managed 10–12 knots in fair weather. Handling stays at -1. Crew set to the frame default plus additional hands — a frigate carried 200–300 souls between gun crews, topmen, marines, and officers.

The main battery: 8× Medium Cannon in Pintle mounts (16 slots). Two Carronades for close-range devastation (2 slots). That's 18 on weapons. Remaining slots go to crew quarters and rigging. We click Export:

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32-GUN FRIGATE
Fifth-rate warship, fast and weatherly.
Size 10 (Huge) • Sail • Handling -1 • Top Speed 12 MPH
Toughness 27(12) • Wounds 5 • Crew 5+200
Weapons: 8× Medium Cannon (Pintle), 2× Carronade (Pintle)
Notes: Enclosed, Heavy Armour
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TIP: *Only one broadside fires per round. Eight guns sounds impressive until you remember half of them point the wrong way. That's why frigate captains spent their careers practising the art of the turn.*

Walkthrough: Assault Walker

"In the void between stars, there are places where wheels sink, tracks jam, and hover fields fail. That's where you send something with legs."

Concept

A far-future assault walker — a bipedal war machine designed for mountain warfare on a hostile colony world. The terrain defeats conventional armour: tracked vehicles can't climb the passes, hover tanks can't hold position in the updrafts, and air support keeps getting swatted by emplaced particle batteries. The general needs something that walks, shoots, and terrifies.

Starting Point: How Tall Is a War Machine?

The engineer sets Locomotion to Biped and starts with Size 8 — the absolute floor, because the Heavy Laser needs minimum Size 8. The stat block reads: Huge frame, Handling -1, Wounds 5, 20 mod slots. The walker-specific Strength stat appears automatically.

He drags weapons into mount points. Heavy Laser into the Turret — 5 slots, counter drops to 15. Two Medium Lasers into Fixed mounts at 3 each — counter to 9. Light Missiles ×8 at 0 slots. Then modifications: Jump Jets (1), Dual Cockpit (-1), Sensor Array (1), Environmental Seal (1). Mod counter reads 7 remaining out of 20.

The Problem: It's Not Big Enough

The general looks at the projected height — 36 feet at Size 8 — and shakes her head. She needs to fire over ridgelines, and she wants the enemy to see this thing from three valleys away. She wants psychological impact as much as firepower.

The engineer tries Size 10. Sixty-three feet tall, 125 tonnes, 25 mod slots. Base Toughness jumps to 15. The extra slots are insurance for field refits. And the silhouette, towering over the tree line, is exactly the weapon the general actually wants.

Dialling In the Stats

Toughness +2 and Armour +3. Huge increments give +8 Toughness and +9 Armour. Result: Toughness 38(15). Autocannon fire bounces. MPH Override to 40 — a brisk stride for something this size. Handling -2, because 125 tonnes of walking metal does not dodge. Crew 2: pilot and gunner in the Dual Cockpit.

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ASSAULT WALKER
Heavy bipedal war machine, mountain warfare specialist.
Size 10 (Huge) • Biped • Handling -2 • Top Speed 40 MPH
Toughness 38(15) • Crew 2 • Wounds 5 • Strength d12+10
Weapons: Heavy Laser (Turret), 2× Medium Laser (Fixed), Light Missiles ×8 (Fixed)
Notes: Heavy Armour, Jump Jets, Dual Cockpit, Sensor Array, Environmental Seal
```

There's no reference build for a walker this size — and that's the point. The reference builds cover common archetypes. The slider system handles everything else. The general gets her mountain-killer. The enemy gets a sixty-three-foot reminder that some problems can't be solved by digging in.

Design Notes & Tips

Don’t Fill Every Slot

The temptation is to spend every available mod slot. Resist it. Real vehicles carry spare capacity, redundant systems, and empty mounting points for future refits. A vehicle with slots remaining is a vehicle with story potential — the crew might upgrade it mid-campaign, or a patron might offer a weapons refit as a reward.

Weapons: Less Is More

Every weapon on a vehicle is a weapon the GM has to track in combat. A tank with one main gun and two machine guns is Fast, Furious, Fun. A tank with eight weapon systems is a spreadsheet. Build for the table, not for the spec sheet.

Turrets Cost Double for a Reason

A turret-mounted weapon can fire in any direction. That flexibility is worth the premium. Mount your main weapon in a turret and everything else fixed or pintle. This concentrates your mod budget on the weapon that matters most.

Drawbacks Are Your Friend

Drawbacks give mod slots back. They also make vehicles interesting. A Temperamental tank with a Bone Shaker suspension is more memorable than a statistically perfect one. Players remember the vehicle that stalled at the worst possible moment.

Special Abilities Tell Stories

A vehicle with Haunted, Cursed, and Sentient is three adventures waiting to happen. A vehicle with Prototype and Unreliable is a bomb with a steering wheel. Use Special Abilities to give vehicles personality, not just statistics.

Scale Matters

A Size 2 car and a Size 18 dreadnought exist in completely different tactical realities. The car is fighting infantry and dodging between buildings. The dreadnought is exchanging broadsides with other capital ships at extreme range. Build for the encounters your campaign will actually have.

The Extension System

"The Forge is a platform, not a destination."

The Vehicle Forge ships with a comprehensive core catalogue, but no single tool can cover every genre's specific needs. The extension system (.vfx files) adds themed content packs that expand the Forge's capabilities for specific genres and campaigns.

Planned Extension Families

The planned catalogue will include packs organised into themed families, each addressing a specific genre or tactical experience:

Blood & Thunder — Naval warfare from ancient galleys to Napoleonic broadsides.

Iron & Steel — Ground warfare from WW2 tanks to modern main battle tanks.

Talons & Contrails — Military aviation from biplanes to stealth fighters.

Chrome & Fury — Modern and near-future vehicles, spy cars, and police interceptors.

Star & Void — Science fiction fleets from fighters to dreadnoughts.

Rust & Ruin — Post-apocalyptic salvage and wasteland survival.

Fang & Claw — Fantasy war beasts, mounts, and siege engines.

Sails & Gasbags — Fantasy skyships, airships, and magical vessels.

Cog & Steam — Steampunk and Victorian-era mechanical wonders.

Wire & Current — Cyberpunk and near-future urban vehicles.

Pack availability, pricing, and release schedule will be confirmed at launch. Check the DiceForge Studios website for the latest catalogue.

What Comes Next

The Vehicle Forge is a living tool. Future updates will expand the core weapon catalogue, add new locomotion types, and refine the construction system based on community feedback.

Vehicle bundles — pre-built fleets for specific genres and campaigns — will provide ready-to-play vehicle collections that snap into the Forge alongside the extension packs. The 47 reference builds are just the beginning.

For the latest products, updates, and community content, visit DiceForge Studios on DriveThruRPG.

Now go build something.

VEHICLE FORGE COMPANION GUIDE

v0.10.12

DiceForge Studios Ltd.
diceforgestudios.pages.dev/vehicle-forge.html